

IT'S TIME FOR A NEW DAWN

The league has undergone a significant transformation ahead of this season. The game, now a whirlwind of speed and physicality, has demanded a **youth movement**, ushering out the legends who once defined it.

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The much-anticipated Pro Kabaddi League (PKL) is set to return for its 11th season, bringing with it a new format, transitioning from the traditional 12-city caravan to a three-city structure that's expected to add a fresh dynamic to the competition.

The stakes have risen as always this year, with the blockbuster signing of Sachin Tanwar (left) by Tamil Thalaivas, along with the big-money moves of Mohammadreza Shadloui Chiyaneh and Sunil Kumar, setting the tone for an explosive season.

As the tournament enters a new decade, most teams have made significant changes at the auction to assemble more balanced squads that are aligned with their playing styles.

Defending champion Puneri Paltan has retained the strong core of players from its title-winning squad, including last season's MVP Aslam Inamdar, giving it a significant edge. However, it failed to hold on to its defensive lynchpin Shadloui but has added a fresh wave of talent to fill the void.

Meanwhile, Thalaivas has taken a bold approach by appointing two coaches, J.



Udaya Kumar and Dharmaraj Cheralathan, before snapping up Sachin for ₹2.15 crores. The Chennai-based team has also held on to defensive stalwarts Sagar Rathee and Sahil Gulia as it aims for its maiden PKL triumph.

Last season's runner-up, Haryana Steelers, has added Shadloui to its already strong defensive core. It will be looking to use the explosive Iranian as an all-rounder, a role he plays with effortless panache for his national side.

Bengal Warriorz brought back Maninder Singh and paired him with his friend Fazel Atrachali. The Kolkata franchise's youthful squad will depend on these two seasoned

